

world outside the element are made at +2 difficulty, and no I Chih may be cast from within the substance, for the Hsien's Chi is still active. Any items besides clothing must be enfolded prior to travel, or they will not pass through the element.

Elemental Form/Fist: By incorporating the element into herself, the Hsien is able to greater resist its depredations, as well as augment her own fighting capabilities. Dice allocated to Degree must be split between these two, or dedicated entirely on one of them. Combinations may be used — wood Form with fire Fist, for example — so long as it feeds the progressive cycle. This requires a Cohort effect.

Wood — The character may add soak dice against wooden attacks, reduce the difficulty of resisting venom or poison, or induce thick thorns to sprout from her hands and feet, allowing her to do lethal damage barehanded.

Fire — The character may add soak dice against flame, though it still does aggravated damage. Additionally, she may cause flames to erupt wherever she strikes, engulfing the foe in flame. Dice allocated during the original I Chih must be split between the intensity and the size of the flame desired.

Earth — The character may add soak dice against stone or earthen attacks, or reduce difficulties associated with inclement weather conditions. She may also harden her fists and feet preternaturally, allowing her to punch through or into dangerous substances without suffering harm and adding to her bashing damage dice pool, one damage for each die allocated.

Metal — The character adds dice to soak any attack made with metal, turning aside blades with bare flesh — with enough power, she may even become literally bulletproof. Her hands and feet, finely-honed instruments hard as steel, are able to precisely target weaknesses in armor and penetrate it, removing the enemy's soak dice from armor on a one-for-one basis.

Water — The character can no longer drown, and may slip out of bindings or grapples with ease, lowering difficulty of such rolls by one per die allocated. Her fists push the very essence of water into her foes, causing them to drown even in the driest of deserts. Victims must make a Stamina + Athletics roll against a difficulty equal to the Hsien's Yin + dice allocated to the effect in order to cough up the water, or they will pass out according to the rules included in the Suffocation & Drowning section (p. 293).

Awaken the Elements

No longer must the Shinma entreat elementals to do her bidding, or work the stuff of the elements with her bare hands — now she commands the elements themselves, controlling them in fine and marvelous detail with nothing more than her will alone. In addition, with her greater understanding of Wu Tan she may now employ Raiment of the Elements against others.

Awaken True Jade: By linking her Chi for but a moment with the latent Chi that sleeps within jade, the Hsien may awaken that jade and create true jade, a mystical and powerful substance much in demand among the Shinma. Awakening jade to a particular kind of Chi requires either a Yin or Yang roll, respectively. To balance the jade's Chi, two rolls, one of each,

are necessary. Regardless of the aspect, every two dice allocated to Degree awakens a point of Chi in the jade.

Elemental Hand: The Hsien is able to move and shape the elements themselves, appropriating them with a form of martial telekinesis. Many actions are possible with this power, such as animating trees or shaping a stone into a rude caricature of a person, but perhaps the simplest technique in this library is to simply attack another with the element in question. The exact form of the attack may vary — high-pressure sprays of water, great gouts of flame, stones torn from the ground itself — but mechanically, all are represented by the I Chih roll, with successes allocated to Degree translating to dice of damage.

Summon Element: Such is the Hsien's understanding of the elements that she can create them ex nihilo, or at least seem to — all things are in balance, and the element must come from somewhere. The Hsien cannot control from where, of course, but she can control its expression.

Throne of Jade

The Hsien unites her understanding of the elements, representing the great cycle. She may transmute elements freely, exchange or alter properties at will — even between different elements, with a Cohort effect. Her mastery evident, the spirits of Heaven's hierarchy recognize her authority, or at least, the foolishness of angering her — should they disobey, she may bind them to the task.

Authority: Spirits may be bound to obey the changeling's dictates. The command must be simple enough to be communicated in a single sentence, and cannot require more than one lunar month of service from the spirit in question. In addition, the Hsien may only levy such a command once per year — any more, and the spirit has grounds to appeal the command to the Celestial Bureaucracy, who are, to put it mildly, unlikely to be pleased by the Hsien's actions. The binding requires a point of Yugen in addition to the one used to invoke this I Chih, and a number of dice allocated to Degree equal to the spirit's Chi divided by 10, rounding down.

Transmutation: Qualities may be exchanged between expressions of a single element. To render a match's flame as intense as a torch, for example, might require one die allocated to Degree, while augmenting it until it burns as hot as an acetylene blowtorch would require significantly more. With cohort effects, properties may be exchanges between expressions of different elements — creating a fire, for example, that is as hard as diamond. Frozen in a single form, it nonetheless burns with a terrific heat. A true master of the elements may even transform an expression of one element into an expression of another — turning wood into gold, or water into flame. To attempt this most rigorous of magics, however, the Hsien must possess both Alchemies at 55555.

Nei Tan

Along with the natural talents of the Shinma, a sixth school of alchemy exists, one that focuses on the self and the soul rather than the world outside the changeling. More akin